names all start with @, are available to all the instance methods of a class. Each object gets its own set of instance variables.

Instance variables aren't directly accessible outside the class. To make them available, write methods that return their values:

```
class Greeter
  def initialize(name)
    @name = name
  end

  def name
    @name
  end

  def name=(new_name)
    @name = new_name
  end
end

g = Greeter.new("Barney")
g.name   # => Barney
g.name = "Betty"
g.name   # => Betty
```

Ruby provides convenience methods that write these accessor methods for you (which is great news for folks tired of writing all those getters and setters):

```
class Greeter
  attr_accessor  :name       # create reader and writer methods
  attr_reader    :greeting   # create reader only
  attr_writer    :age        # create writer only
end
```

A class's instance methods are public by default; anyone can call them. You'll probably want to override this for methods that are intended to be used only by other instance methods:

```
class MyClass
  def m1      # this method is public
  end
  protected
```